

Career Compass — Meta Ads Automation Playbook

Facebook + Instagram paid acquisition, India · Prepared for Koenig AI Academy · 17 Jun 2026

Career Compass academy.koenig-solutions.com India Meta Marketing API

After confirming Naukri/InfoEdge has **no third-party advertising option** for an upskilling service, Meta (Facebook + Instagram) is our primary paid channel — and the only one that fits the "advertising on auto-drive" goal. This playbook covers the automation surface, the AI features to use, the open-source components to reuse, the account/API setup, and a low cost-per-acquisition (CPA) campaign blueprint.

Two findings that make this much faster than expected:

- 1) **Meta now has an OFFICIAL Ads MCP server** (launched 29 Apr 2026, `mcp.facebook.com/ads`): 29 tools, sign-in with Facebook Business, **no app review**, free open beta — it plugs Meta ads straight into our Claude/Paperclip agents.
- 2) **We do NOT need Meta App Review** — advertising on our *own* account via our own software only needs a **System User token**. We auto-qualify for the higher API rate tier after ~2 weeks of clean use. No multi-week review gate.

1. Recommended automation architecture (reuse > build)

Layer	Adopt	Why
Execution (write)	Official Meta Ads MCP	First-party, no review, native Claude connector; create/update/pause campaigns, budgets, insights, diagnostics
Fallback / batch	<code>facebook-python-business-sdk v25</code> (official, 1.6k★)	Anything the 29 MCP tools don't cover; Paperclip is Python
Diagnosis brain	<code>meta-ads-analyzer</code> (366★, MIT — a Claude-Code skill)	Encodes Meta's learning-phase / creative-fatigue / breakdown-effect logic
Autopilot blueprint	<code>meta-ads-kit</code> (258★, MIT)	Budget pacing + fatigue detection + paused-by-default staging = our loop
Conversion signal	CAPI via the SDK's built-in sender	Server-side <code>analysis_completed</code> with high match quality

The one thing we build ourselves — a guardrail layer. The official MCP has **no confirmation step and does not auto-pause** new campaigns ("a hallucinated prompt can spend real money"). We add: account-level daily budget caps, a *create-everything-paused* agent policy, separate read-only (diagnosis) vs write (execution) tokens, and statistical-significance scaling rules. No mature open-source version of this exists — it's our differentiator.

2. Meta AI features to ride for low CPA

- **Advantage+ Audience** (broad + India geo) — the biggest lever, **~32% lower CPA** vs manual; fully API-controllable. Note: Meta **removed most detailed-interest targeting in Jan 2026** — "broad + AI" is now the playbook (seed with a few interest hints while signal is thin).
- **Advantage+ Creative** (AI text, background generation, image uncrop) + **Flexible Ads** — ship 5–10 variants in one unit; Meta optimizes per user without resetting learning.
- **Automated Rules via API** (`adrules_library`) — native safety-net rules (CPA kill-switch, runaway-spend pause) run on Meta's infra *even if our agent is offline*; the `PING_ENDPOINT` action can call our own webhook.
- **Conversions API + Event Match Quality** — sending hashed email/phone/name lifts match quality to 7–9 → **~12% lower CPA**. Career Compass already collects strong identifiers.

- **Watch, don't depend on:** Meta's "give us a URL + budget, AI builds everything" mode — real, but Ads-Manager-only, public ~Q4 2026.

3. Account + API setup (condensed checklist)

1. **Business Manager** (business.facebook.com) → **verify** with GST / CIN / PAN (3–5 days, run in parallel).
2. **Facebook Page** for Career Compass (required) + optional Instagram for Reels.
3. **Ad account** — currency **INR**, timezone Asia/Kolkata (both locked after creation).
4. **Payment** — **prepaid** + UPI/card, **OTP** on the method (mandatory in India), add **GSTIN** for input-tax credit. Prepaid avoids India eMandate/auto-charge failures.
5. **Pixel / dataset** on the site + **domain verification**; define custom conversion `analysis_completed` in Events Manager.
6. **Developer app** (developers.facebook.com, type "Business") → add Marketing API → note App ID/Secret (can stay in "development").
7. **System User** (admin) → assign Ad Account + Page + Dataset + App → generate a **non-expiring token** with `ads_management`, `ads_read`, `business_management`.
8. **Conversions API** — generate a CAPI token on the dataset; backend POSTs `analysis_completed` with hashed identifiers + an `event_id` matching the pixel for dedup.

Access tiers: default Development (~60 quota pts/300s) works on our own account with no review; run clean for ~2 weeks (500+ calls, <15% errors) to auto-qualify for the higher ~9,000-pt tier. Advanced/Full access (App Review) only needed to manage other people's accounts — not us.

4. Low-CPA campaign blueprint (India, our ICP)

Structure — consolidate, don't fragment

- **Campaign 1 — Prospecting** (CBO / Advantage+ campaign budget): 1–2 broad ad sets, Advantage+ Audience, optimize for `analysis_completed`.
- **Campaign 2 — Creative testing** (ABO, equal budgets) → promote winners into Campaign 1.
- **Campaign 3 — Retargeting** (CBO): site visitors + video viewers + Page/IG engagers who didn't finish an analysis.

Optimization-event ladder (critical for a free, low-data tool)

Start on **Traffic / an upper-funnel event** to seed the pixel → switch to `analysis_completed` once ~50 events/week → later optimize toward the **paid ₹99/₹199 conversion** as volume grows.

Targeting & creative

- Broad India; age ~18–34 (freshers/students) and ~24–40 (working IT pros); English + Hinglish. Add **lookalikes (1–3%)** of converters + retargeting as data builds.
- **Reels-first, vertical 9:16**, hook in 1–2s ("Paste your CV, get your skill gaps in 30 seconds — free"). **5–10 variants**; UGC / talking-head beats polished brand ads.

Budget & pacing

- Exit learning ≈ 50 events/ad-set/week → **~₹1,500–2,500/day per ad set** floor. Scale winners **≤15–20% every 2–3 days** (big jumps reset learning). Avoid edits during learning.
- **Warm up the new account:** start ₹400–800/day, **≤20%** increases — don't dump ₹1L on day one (~78% of new accounts hit a restriction otherwise).

Honest India numbers

Metric	Range (India, education/career, 2026)
CPM	~₹200–250 (among the cheapest globally)
CPC	~₹1.5–4 (education/coaching)
Cost per completed CV-analysis (free action)	~₹30–60 at maturity (₹100–150 during early learning)
₹1,00,000 / ~30 days	≈ 1,600–3,300 completed analyses (first ~₹20–30k = learning spend)

5. Risks & guardrails

- **Special Ad Category:** targeting job-seekers *could* make Meta classify our ads as "Employment" (restricts targeting). We advertise a *tool*, not job openings, so likely not — **verify before launch**.
- **Autonomous-write safety:** the official MCP won't auto-pause or confirm — our guardrail layer (caps, paused-by-default, split tokens) is mandatory.
- **AI-content policy (2026):** AI-generated creative gets auto "Made with AI" labels and still passes Meta review — build a human-review/appeal fallback.
- **Account restrictions:** scale gradually; abrupt spend spikes / device or payment irregularities can auto-disable a new India account.

6. Recommended first moves

1. Create the Meta Business account + Page + ad account (prepaid/UPI/GSTIN/OTP) and verify the business — start the 2-week API warm-up clock.
2. Install Pixel + domain verification + CAPI for `analysis_completed`.
3. Connect the official Meta Ads MCP to Paperclip behind our guardrail layer (create-paused, budget caps, split tokens).
4. Launch a ₹500/day warm-up campaign (Traffic) → graduate to `analysis_completed` → then the ₹1L test; let the agent monitor/optimize with native safety-net rules as backstop.

Sources: Meta developer blog & docs (Graph/Marketing API v25, Feb–May 2026), Meta Ads MCP launch coverage (Apr 2026), facebook-python-business-sdk, pipeboard/meta-ads-mcp, meta-ads-kit, meta-ads-analyzer, and 2025–2026 India CPM/CPC/CPL benchmark sources. Full citations in the research record.